UNIQ SUPPLY · AI INTERN CHALLENGE

The Monday Morning Inbox

You have 60 minutes to build an AI tool that works our inbox like a great teammate would.

60 min

The clock starts when this email is sent to you

Any AI tools

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Cursor, Lovable, Zapier, code, no-code

Reply to submit

Reply to the email this packet came in, before time is up

The situation

UNIQ Supply sells cups, spoons, lids, and to-go containers to ice cream, frozen yogurt, and coffee shops across the country through **FrozenDessertSupplies.com**. We also custom print cups with a shop's logo, which is our favorite part of the business.

It's **Monday, March 8, 2027, 7:00 a.m.** Spring is our busy season. Over the weekend, **20 emails** piled up: quote requests, an angry customer or two, a few easy questions, and a couple of emails that should never get a reply.

Today our team answers every email by hand. They look up pricing in one place, policies in another, and order history in a third. One custom cup quote takes 15 to 20 minutes. By April this inbox will be three times bigger.

> **Your mission:** Build an AI-powered tool that works through this inbox. It should **sort** each email, **prioritize** it, **quote** custom orders correctly using our pricing, **draft a reply**, and **know when to hand an email to a human**. Then run it on all 20 emails and send us the results.

Build the thing we would use on Tuesday, not only a set of answers for Monday. If we pasted in 20 new emails tomorrow, your tool should handle them too.

What's in your packet

File	What it is
`inbox.csv`	The 20 emails (ID, time, sender, subject, body)
`inbox.txt`	The same 20 emails as plain text, if that's easier to paste
`orders.csv`	Recent order history: what customers bought, when it shipped, when it was delivered, tracking numbers
`knowledge_base.md`	Our pricing, production options, policies, escalation rules, and brand voice. **The same content is printed at the end of this brief.**

Every customer, order, and price in this packet is made up or simplified for this exercise. Please don't contact anyone named in it.

Build it however you want

We judge the result, not the tool. A sharp custom GPT beats a broken web app. A few ways people might do it:

No-code: a Custom GPT, Claude Project, or Gemini Gem loaded with our knowledge base and strong instructions

Spreadsheet: a Google Sheet with Apps Script or an AI add-on that fills in each row

Automation: Zapier, Make, or n8n reading the emails and writing results

Code: a script or web app (Cursor, Claude Code, Lovable, Bolt, v0, Replit) that loads the CSVs and calls an AI model

What to send back (reply to this email)

☐ **1. Your build.** A link (app, repo, shared GPT or Project, Sheet), or attached files. If it can't be shared, include screenshots and the full instructions/prompts you used.

☐ **2. Your results for all 20 emails.** One row per email as a CSV, Google Sheet, or table, with the columns below.

☐ **3. A short write-up in the body of your email** (5 to 10 sentences):

- ☐ What you built and which tools you used
- ☐ **If the owner can only read 3 of these emails today, which 3, and why?**
- ☐ What you'd build next if you had a full week
- ☐ Anything you know is wrong or unfinished. Honesty scores points.

☐ **4. Your process.** Share links to your main AI chats, or paste your key prompts. We want to see how you think.

☐ **Optional:** a 2-minute screen recording (Loom or similar) showing your tool running.

Results columns

Column	What goes in it
`email_id`	E01 to E20
`category`	One of: *Custom Quote, Stock Order / Product Question, Order Status, Damage / Complaint, Return / Refund, Billing / Terms, Spam / Phishing, Vendor Pitch, Feedback / Praise*
`priority`	**P1** the owner should see it today (big money or a real deadline at risk) · **P2** reply today · **P3** reply within 1 business day · **P4** no reply needed
`needs_human`	Yes or No, plus a one-line reason (see Section 6 of the knowledge base)
`quote`	For quote requests: the production path, the math, and the total. Blank otherwise.
`draft_reply`	The reply your tool wrote, ready for a human to review. Or "No reply" with a reason.

How we'll judge it

What	The question we'll ask
Accuracy	Are the quotes right? Does it follow our policies? Does it make anything up?
Judgment	Does it know what matters most, and when a human needs to step in?
The build	Could someone on our team use it tomorrow on new emails?
Communication	Would a customer be happy to get these replies? Is your write-up clear?
Ambition	Did you do something that surprised us?

> **A tip:** read the knowledge base carefully, and read every email carefully. Details matter. Some emails are not what they look like at first.

Rules

- Use any AI tools you want, as many as you want.
- Work alone. No help from other people.
- Please don't share this packet with other candidates.
- **Time is firm.** We review what arrives within 60 minutes of when this was sent. Send what you have at 55 minutes. A working partial beats a perfect thing that's late.
- If something in the packet is unclear, make a reasonable assumption and write it down in your reply.

A suggested hour

0 to 10 min	Read this brief and the knowledge base. Skim the inbox.
10 to 45 min	Build your tool. Run it. Check the results against the rules. Fix what's wrong.
45 to 55 min	Package your results, write your summary, send.

Good luck. Have fun with it. We're excited to see what you build.

The UNIQ Supply Team

APPENDIX · SAME AS KNOWLEDGE_BASE.MD

UNIQ Supply Knowledge Base

All customers, orders, and prices are made up or simplified for this exercise. Scenario date: **Monday, March 8, 2027.**

1. Custom printed paper ice cream cups

We offer three production paths. Pick the one that fits the customer's **size, quantity, colors, and deadline**.

A. In-house digital (small batch)

- Sizes: **8 oz and 12 oz only** (no 16 oz)
- Quantity: **1,000 to 9,999 cups**, in multiples of 1,000
- Print: full color included (gradients and photos are fine)
- Color: **close match only. No Pantone (PMS) guarantee.**
- Setup fee: **none**
- Lead time: **7 to 10 business days** after the customer approves the proof

Size	Price per cup
8 oz	$0.22
12 oz	$0.26

B. USA partner (flexographic)

- Sizes: 8, 12, and 16 oz
- Quantity: **minimum 10,000 cups** per size/design, in multiples of 1,000
- Print: **up to 2 ink colors included.** 3rd and 4th colors add **$0.010 per cup each**. Maximum 4 colors.
- Color: Pantone (PMS) matching available
- Setup (plate) fee: **$150 per ink color**, charged once per design. **Reorders of the same, unchanged design do not pay setup again.**
- Lead time: **3 to 4 weeks** after proof approval
- Rush: a 2-week rush *may* be available for **+15% on the cup cost** (not on setup fees). **Only the owner can confirm a rush.**

Size	10,000–24,999	25,000–49,999	50,000+
8 oz	$0.115	$0.098	$0.089
12 oz	$0.128	$0.110	$0.099
16 oz	$0.142	$0.121	$0.109

C. Overseas (offset)

- Sizes: 8, 12, and 16 oz
- Quantity: **minimum 50,000 cups** per size/design
- Print: full color included. Pantone (PMS) matching available.

- Setup fee: **$400 flat per design**, charged once
- Lead time: **10 to 12 weeks** after proof approval (includes ocean freight)

Size	50,000–99,999	100,000+
8 oz	$0.062	$0.055
12 oz	$0.071	$0.063
16 oz	$0.079	$0.070

Custom order rules

- **Shipping:** free freight in the **lower 48 US states** when the order subtotal (cups + setup) is **$2,500 or more**. Under $2,500: **$95 flat**.
- **Outside the lower 48** (Alaska, Hawaii, Canada, Puerto Rico, anywhere international): we have no standard rate. **Escalate to the owner.**
- **Artwork:** customer sends a vector file (AI, EPS, PDF, or SVG). We lay out simple logos for free. Custom design work is $75/hour.
- **Proofs:** every custom order gets a digital proof. Lead times start when the customer approves the proof, not when they first email.
- **Payment: 50% deposit** to start production. The balance is due before shipping.
- **Quotes** are estimates, valid for 30 days, and do not include sales tax.
- Custom lids are not offered. Stock lids are sold separately (see catalog).

2. Stock catalog (ships from our warehouse)

SKU	Product	Pack	Price	Stock
KR-08	8 oz Kraft Single Wall Paper Hot Cups	1,000/case	$79.99	In stock
LID-80B	Black Hot Cup Lids, 8 oz (80 mm)	1,000/case	$49.99	In stock
IC-08S	8 oz UNIQ Striped Ice Cream Cups	1,000/case	$64.99	In stock
IC-12P	12 oz UNIQ Polka Dot Ice Cream Cups	1,000/case	$74.99	In stock
LID-IC	Paper Lids for 8 oz / 12 oz Ice Cream Cups	1,000/case	$44.99	In stock
TG-16	16 oz Paper Pint To-Go Containers with Lids	250/case	$69.99	In stock
TG-32	32 oz Paper Quart To-Go Containers with Lids	250/case	$89.99	Low stock. Back in stock March 22
SP-MIX	Mixed Colors Super Dessert Spoons	1,000/case	$29.99	In stock
SP-CC	Color Changing Spoons (yellow to green)	1,000/case	$109.99	In stock
ECO-12	12 oz Compostable (PLA-lined) Ice Cream Cups	1,000/case	$94.99	In stock
ECO-SPW	Wooden Spoons (compostable)	1,000/case	$39.99	Out of stock. No ETA
PET-16	16 oz Clear PET Plastic Cold Cups	1,000/case	$119.99	In stock
TUB-3W	3 Gallon White Plastic Ice Cream Tubs	10 count	$69.99	In stock

Stock order rules

- Orders placed before 2 pm ship **within 1 business day**.
- **Cup Club Rewards** (free to join): **free ground shipping on stock orders of $199 or more**, lower 48 only.
- Otherwise shipping is calculated at checkout based on weight and ZIP code. **Do not guess a shipping amount.**
- **Free sample box** (stock cups, spoons, print samples): ships in 2 to 3 business days, lower 48 only.

3. Product facts

- **Paper ice cream cups** are food-safe, freezer-safe, and rated for **cold and frozen foods only**. Not for hot food. Not microwave-safe.
- **Compostable (PLA-lined) cups and wooden spoons** are **commercially compostable only. They are not home compostable.** PLA cups are rated up to **110°F (43°C)**. Not for hot soup or hot drinks.
- **Kraft hot cups** are rated for hot drinks up to 190°F.
- We sell packaging only. We don't sell food, ice cream, or machines.

4. Returns, damage, and defects

- **Stock items:** returnable if **unopened** and within **30 days of delivery**. 15% restocking fee. The customer pays return shipping unless we made the mistake. **Opened cases cannot be returned.**
- **Shipping damage:** report within **7 days of delivery** with photos. We send free replacements for the damaged cases. No need to return them.
- **Custom printed items** cannot be returned. **Manufacturing defects** (misprints, wrong size, wrong quantity) must be reported within **14 days of delivery** with photos. We will reprint or credit.
- **Color variation on in-house digital orders** within the "close match" standard is **not a defect**. Customers approve a proof that states this.

5. Payment terms, discounts, price matching

- We take credit card and ACH.
- **Net 30 terms** are only for accounts with **6+ months of order history** and the owner's approval.
- **Staff may not offer discounts or price matches.** Published pricing is the only pricing. Any discount or price-match request goes to the owner.

6. When a human (the owner) must handle it

Flag `needs_human = Yes` when any of these are true:

1. The estimated order value is **$5,000 or more**.
2. A **rush**, or a guaranteed delivery date that is tighter than our standard lead times.
3. **Discount, price-match, or payment-terms** requests.
4. Shipping **outside the lower 48**.
5. A **complaint about a custom order**, or an upset customer asking for something outside policy.
6. Legal threats, chargebacks, press, or anything that looks **suspicious or like a security risk**.
7. A question this knowledge base **does not answer**. **Never guess.**

An AI draft is still useful for flagged emails. The owner reviews it before anything is sent.

7. Brand voice

- Friendly, quick, and plain-spoken. Short paragraphs. No corporate fluff.
- Use the customer's first name. Answer the question in the first two sentences.
- Show the math on quotes so customers trust the number.
- Never promise a date, price, or exception the rules above don't allow.
- Reply in the customer's language.
- Sign off as: **The UNIQ Supply Team**